

IRP Workshop Notes

13 May 2026 · Weijie Li · RCA Global Innovation Design
Why Eating Well Feels Like Nothing — IRP Realisation Unit

1. IRP Core Theme / 项目核心主题

Can good eating be designed into the environment and feedback, not the willpower?

好好吃饭，能不能靠环境设计和反馈机制，而不是靠意志力？

In your own words / 用你自己的话说

I couldn't stick to eating well myself — not from lack of knowledge, but because nothing happens after a healthy meal. That silence is the design problem.

我自己无法坚持健康饮食，不是因为不知道，而是因为吃得好之后什么感觉都没有。那种沉默本身就是问题所在。

2. Tutorial: Three Questions / 导师课三个问题

Q1 — What did you create?

Can good eating be designed into the environment and feedback, not the willpower?

好好吃饭，能不能靠环境设计和反馈，而不是靠意志力？

Q2 — Why this, why now?

Because I couldn't stick to eating well myself. Not from lack of knowledge — but because nothing happens after a healthy meal. No signal, no reward, nothing. That emptiness felt like a design problem nobody had seriously solved.

因为我自己做不到。不是因为不知道——而是因为吃完一顿健康的饭什么都不会发生。没有信号，没有奖励，什么都没有。那个空白感觉像是一个没有人认真解决过的设计问题。

Q3 — Who or what informed your approach?

My own failure first. Then Fogg's behaviour model explained why — no signal, no reinforcement. Nudge theory and food environment research showed that small physical changes work better than willpower. And Intuitive Eating drew the ethical line: the goal is to

help people trust their own body, not replace it with a score.

首先是我自己的失败经历。然后 Fogg 的行为模型解释了原因——没有信号就没有强化。Nudge 理论和食物环境研究表明，微小的物理改变比意志力更有效。直觉饮食划定了伦理边界：目标是帮助人们信任自己的身体，而不是用分数替代它。

3. Signal-to-Scenario: The Listening Body / 身体倾听时代

Signal (from IRP research)

Broken interoceptive trust — people have lost the ability to read their own hunger and satiety signals, not because the signals don't exist, but because modern food environments and tracking culture have overridden them.

内感受信任的断裂——人们失去了读取自己饥饱信号的能力，不是因为信号不存在，而是因为现代食物环境和追踪文化覆盖了它们。

Name Your World

The Listening Body / 身体倾听时代

Three Differences in Daily Life

- Kitchens are designed like Krukow/COOP — vegetables at eye level, healthy food visible by default. Nobody counts calories, but behaviour changes anyway. 厨房像超市货架一样被设计——蔬菜放在视线高度，健康食物默认可见。没有人记卡路里，但行为悄悄改变了。
- After every meal, people pause 20 minutes — not to log food, but to ask: heavy or light? Satisfied or hollow? The pause itself becomes a daily norm. 每顿饭后人们停下来 20 分钟——不是记录食物，而是感受：沉重还是轻盈？满足还是空洞？这个停顿成为日常习惯。
- Eating while scrolling a phone is considered bad manners — distraction-free, slower eating becomes the cultural default. 边刷手机边吃饭变得不礼貌——专注、缓慢地进食成为文化默认值。

One Constant

People still eat emotionally — for comfort, stress, boredom. The desire for pleasure and relief never disappears.

人还是会情绪性进食——用食物缓解压力、无聊、悲伤。这个人性的需求永远不会消失。

Dominant Value

- Reward: Body awareness · eating without guilt · trusting your own signals 奖励：身体觉知 · 不带愧疚地吃饭 · 信任自己的感受
 - Punish: Eating on autopilot · needing an app to tell you if a meal was okay · ignoring your body 惩罚：无意识进食 · 需要 app 告诉你吃得对不对 · 忽视自己身体的声音
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4. Future Persona: Oliver (Survivor) / 未来人物角色

Domain 1: Demographics

- Name & age: Oliver, 25
- Location: London / Shenzhen, travels globally for work / 伦敦/深圳，全球出差
- Occupation: Entrepreneur / freelancer / 创业者/自由职业者

Domain 2: Basic Facts

- Appearance/manner: Disciplined but joyless / 自律但无趣
- Social world: Surrounded by people who don't care about food, or just eat less. Nobody eats well and enjoys it. He is alone in his struggle. / 身边大多数人不在乎吃什么，少数人靠少吃解决。没有人吃得好又享受，他的挣扎很孤独。
- Future object: A post-meal voice companion — asks how he felt, shows a progress bar toward long-term health. He uses it every day, but secretly doesn't trust the data. When he eats something 'bad', the progress bar terrifies him. / 一个餐后语音对话装置——问他感受，显示远离慢性疾病的进度条。他每天都用，但不确定数据是真的。吃了不健康的东西，那个进度条让他恐惧。

Domain 3: Mindset & Values

- Deepest want: To finish a meal and just know — without doubt, without checking — that it was okay. / 吃完一顿饭，不需要怀疑、不需要核对，就知道：这顿饭没问题。
- Fears: That his body is lying to him. That 'I feel full' means he already ate too much. / 他的身体在骗他。他的身体在骗他，感觉饱了其实已经吃多了。
- Core belief: The world now rewards people who can feel their body. He can't. So the new world has just created a new way to fail. / 这个世界奖励能感知身体的人。他做不到。所以新世界只是创造了一种新的失败方式。

- Views towards organisations: Wants to believe design can help — but every gentle intervention feels like one more thing he is doing wrong. / 想相信设计能帮助他——但每个温和干预都让他感觉自己又多了一件做不对的事。
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5. Causal Layered Analysis (CLA) / 因果层次分析

We cannot change a system without changing the thinking that shapes it.

不改变塑造系统的思维方式，就无法改变系统本身。

Applied to your IRP topic

- Headline: People can't stick to healthy eating / 人们无法坚持健康饮食
- System: Calorie apps, food industry, health tech / 卡路里 app、食品工业、健康科技
- Worldview: The body must be managed by external data / 身体必须被外部数据管理
- Myth/Metaphor: The body is a machine that needs to be controlled / 身体是需要被控制的机器

New Narrative (your IRP's contribution)

The body already knows the answer. You just need to relearn how to listen to it.

身体本来就知道答案。你只需要重新学会听它说话。

6. Research Methods / 研究方法

Autoethnography / 自我民族志

- Step 1 — Position: I am the user. I have personally failed to sustain healthy eating not from lack of knowledge, but because eating well produces no immediate feeling of success. / 我就是用户。我自己无法坚持健康饮食，不是因为不知道，而是因为吃得好之后没有任何成功的感觉。
- Step 2 — Entry point: Every time I order takeout, I face the same moment: I want to eat healthily, but nothing pulls me toward it. After I finish, I genuinely don't know if it was okay. / 每次点外卖，我都面对同一个时刻：想吃健康的，但没有任何东西把我拉向那个选择。吃完后，我真的不知道这顿饭算不算好。

- Step 3 — Data collection: One week, after every main meal — one aftermath photo, three lines (where, how body feels, did it feel okay). No numbers. / 一周时间，每顿饭后：一张饭后现场照片，三行记录。不用数字。
- Step 4 — Reduce bias: Compare my experience with 6–8 interview participants and cross-reference with literature. / 把我的经历和 6-8 个访谈参与者对比，参照现有文献。

DITL — Day In The Life / 日常生活跟踪观察

- Subject: A 25–35 year old who actively tries to eat well but struggles — orders takeout, tried tracking apps, feels uncertain after meals. / 一个 25-35 岁、认真想吃好但做不到的人——点外卖，用过追踪 app，吃完饭不确定自己吃得对不对。
- Time window: 30 min before meal, during meal, 20 min after — the moment of decision and the moment of uncertainty. / 饭前 30 分钟、用餐中、饭后 20 分钟——决策发生和不确定感最强的时刻。
- What to surface: The micro-decisions nobody talks about. The gap between what they say they do and what they actually do. / 那些没人说出口的微小决策。他们说的和实际做的之间的落差。
- Data collection: Timestamped notes, environment photos, one question only after meal: 'What does your body feel like right now?' / 带时间戳的笔记，环境照片，饭后只问一个问题：你现在身体感觉怎么样？
- Reduce risk: Observe 3 meal types (home cook / takeout / eating out). Reframe study as 'eating environment' not 'eating behaviour' to reduce Hawthorne effect. / 观察三种用餐场景。把研究重点定义为用餐环境而不是饮食行为，减少霍桑效应。

7. Participatory Futures / 参与式未来

Not experts predicting the future, but real people imagining and designing it together.

不是专家预测未来，而是让真实的人一起想象和设计未来。

In your research, ask participants: 'If something could tell you a little about how your meal went — without numbers — what would you want it to feel like?' This is participatory futures: letting them co-create the design direction.

在研究里问参与者：如果有什么东西能告诉你一点关于这顿饭的感受——不用数字——你希望它是什么感觉？这就是参与式未来：让他们共同创造设计方向。

